



Planning Application Covering Email

Subject: | JH03 | Romer Cottage - Planning Documents Pack

Date: | 20th August 2025

Dear Stafford BC Planning Team,

I'm writing to submit an updated proposal for Romer Cottage in Burston. This is our second application following the previous scheme being refused on the grounds of scale and dominance in relation to the host dwelling.

The revised submission represents a comprehensive and carefully considered redesign in direct response to the concerns raised by both the Case Officer, Mr Ed Handley, and the Third Party Design Review. At significant cost, the applicants have substantially altered the scheme to ensure a more sensitive, balanced, and contextually appropriate proposal. The principal issue of excessive ridge height has been fully addressed through the adoption of lowered flat roof forms, while further design refinements improve the relationship of the extension to both existing cottages and the wider rural setting. The proposals now deliver a more discreet and harmonious development, with ecological, visual, and functional enhancements embedded throughout.

Supporting Documentation

- JH03_T02_D02-FloorPlans__Scheme-02__Rev-G.pdf
 - JH03_T02_D03-Elevations__Scheme-02__Rev-G.pdf
 - JH03_T02_D21-Site-Plans__Rev-G.pdf
 - Completed Application Form (Downloaded From The Planning Portal As Advised).
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Application Payment

I attempted to make payment today using your online system, however, although the website states that planning payments are accepted online, the required option does not appear in the drop-down menu. After further research, it appears that this is a known issue others have also raised. By the time I had confirmed this, the telephone payment line had closed. I will therefore call tomorrow to make payment directly.

PlanVision Web Tool

For convenience, the full suite of drawings can also be viewed and downloaded via the following link:

https://www.noble-architecture.com/na-project-portal/25-Projects/JH03_RomerCottage/JH03_PlanVision__WebApp

This platform provides integrated measuring tools which enable quick and accurate assessment of areas and lengths. Measurements function correctly on the floor plans, elevations, and 1:500 site plans. Additional supporting material may also be added to this hub over time, making it the live documentation resource for the project moving forward.

[Access Drawings : Click Here](#)

Application Updates Vs Prior

Change Of Use | Guest Cottage Integration

- The proposal seeks to reclassify the existing guest cottage from a Class C1 Holiday Let to form part of the main residential dwelling.
 - A new single storey linking structure has been introduced, unifying the two cottages into a coherent whole while maintaining their individual character.
 - This link has been carefully designed at a significantly lowered height to sit discreetly between the two buildings, ensuring it does not compete with or overwhelm either cottage.
 - The integration allows the site to function as a single, sustainable family home rather than a split-use arrangement, while the architectural treatment of the link reinforces continuity and balance across the scheme.
 - The approach achieves both practical improvement and a more harmonious composition, strengthening the relationship between the buildings and their wider rural setting.
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Critical Design Update | Biodiverse Green Roof

- A key update to the proposal is the introduction of a biodiverse green roof system to the flat roof section of the extension. This living roof will be planted with endemic Staffordshire wildflowers, sedums, and grasses, carefully selected for resilience, minimal maintenance, and habitat creation.
 - The system provides significant environmental benefits, particularly in relation to drainage. By retaining rainwater within the planted substrate, the roof dramatically reduces surface water run-off, helping to mitigate localised flooding issues and easing pressure on the existing drainage network.
 - Beyond sustainability benefits, the green roof will function as a microhabitat, providing food sources and shelter for insects, pollinators, and small bird species. This ecological enhancement aligns closely with Policy N4 of the Local Plan, directly contributing to biodiversity gain within the site.
 - The visual impact is also softened, with the natural planting blending into the wider landscape character, ensuring the extension sits harmoniously within its rural setting. The roof thus addresses multiple objectives - ecological enhancement, flood mitigation, sustainability, and visual integration - while adding long-term environmental value to the scheme.
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Improvement | Covered Veranda Changed To Freestanding Pergola

- The pitched roof previously proposed for the Veranda on the the last has been removed to ensure the structure no longer presents as a dominant architectural element.
 - Instead, the pergola is now designed as a lightweight substructure intended for climbing plants such as Wisteria and Honeysuckle. These species are native and pollinator-friendly, ensuring that the structure contributes to biodiversity enhancement across the site.
 - By encouraging natural planting growth rather than a formal roof covering, the pergola will soften the external environment, provide shade in summer months, and support the wider ecological ambitions of the proposal.
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Improvement | Chimney Height Reduction

- The feature chimney has been substantially reduced in scale, lowering its height by approximately 800mm.
 - This adjustment decreases the overall massing and visual prominence of the chimney, ensuring it no longer competes with the main cottage ridge line or dominates external views.
 - The revised proportions retain the aesthetic presence of a traditional chimney but achieve a more balanced relationship with both the host building and the new extension.
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Reinstatement | Main Cottage Bedroom Window

- The large curtain wall window serving the first-floor bedroom of the larger cottage, where the applicant resides, has been reinstated into the proposal.
- In the previous design, this opening was blocked up due to the pitched roof intersection, leaving the bedroom reliant solely on rooflights. The revised scheme with the significantly lowered flat roof now allows full retention of the window.
- This ensures generous natural light floods the bedroom, maintaining the cottage's character and delivering a clear improvement over the last scheme.

- The glazed doors within the curtain wall will not provide access to the roof. A fixed Juliet glazing panel will be installed in front, preventing use of the roof as a balcony. The doors will serve solely as emergency egress.

Driveway Facing Elevation | Total Redesign

- Following the removal of the large connecting roof between the two cottages, now replaced with significantly lowered flat roofs, the window arrangement has been completely reconsidered.
- The extensive glazing around the front entrance has been reduced to a pair of slim side lights, paired with a solid oak panel door to provide a stronger, more traditional entry focal point.
- With the redesign of the roof, the former apex windows are no longer feasible. Their removal has also allowed the replacement of the previously proposed composite black cladding with instead oak cladding. This matches the oak batten detail on the rear elevation and creates a more consistent material palette.
- The revised approach reduces the number of finishes and establishes a rustic, harmonious character that better complements the cottages and surrounding charming rural contextual setting, moving away from the more contemporary feel of the previous scheme.

Reinstatement | Existing Guest Cottage Window

- The existing first-floor cottage window serving the staircase and landing within the smaller cottage has been reinstated into the current proposal.
- In the earlier design, the pitched slate roof intersected with this opening, necessitating its removal. The revision, incorporating the biodiverse flat roof system, provides sufficient clearance between the deck and roof line to fully retain the window.
- This change ensures that natural daylight continues to illuminate the circulation core of the cottage, maintaining its character and improving the internal environment without compromise to the extension form.

Please do not hesitate to contact me if you have any queries.

Warm Regards,



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